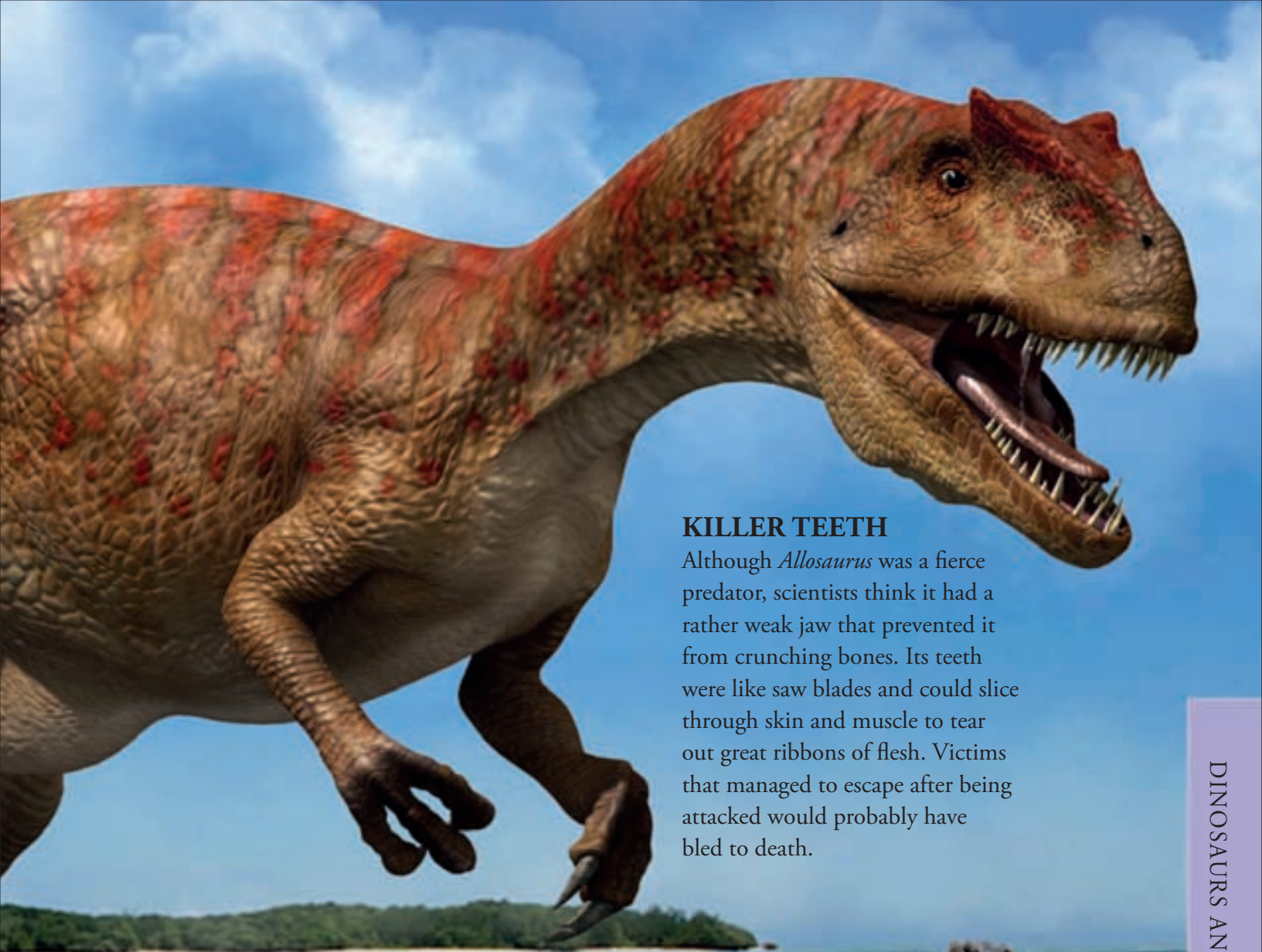




KILLER TEETH

Although *Allosaurus* was a fierce predator, scientists think it had a rather weak jaw that prevented it from crunching bones. Its teeth were like saw blades and could slice through skin and muscle to tear out great ribbons of flesh. Victims that managed to escape after being attacked would probably have bled to death.

Allosaurus

al-oh-SORE-us



- **When** 150 million years ago (Late Jurassic)
- **Fossil location** USA, Portugal
- **Habitat** Plains
- **Length** 39 ft (12 m)
- **Diet** Meat

When young, *Allosaurus* was a fast runner and probably actively chased after prey, sprinting on its long and powerful hindlimbs. Older individuals were heavier and probably relied more on ambushing victims than running them down. The long, curved claws on the hands were used like meat hooks to capture prey. As well as hunting, *Allosaurus* may have also scavenged on dead animals.

▼ **HOLEY SKULL** *The massive skull had large openings that made it lightweight, yet strong. The bone was also riddled with smaller holes that may have contained air sacs linked to the lungs.*

Deep and narrow jaw



Teeth had serrated edges like a saw

Tail held outstretched for balance

Triangular horns in front of each eye, perhaps for display

